Typically, this number is between 4 and 50. A keyer differs from a keyboard, which has "no board", but the keys are arranged in a cluster.

Output Devices:

(1) Monitor: Monitor is the most commonly used output device to display the information. It looks like a TV. Pictures on a monitor are formed with picture elements called PIXELS. Monitors may either be Monochrome which display text or images in Black and White or can be color, which display results in multiple colors. There are many types of monitors available such as CRT (Cathode Ray Tube), LCD (Liquid Crystal Display) and LED (Light Emitting Diodes). The monitor works with the VGA (Video Graphics Array) card. The video graphics card helps the keyboard to communicate with the screen. It acts as an interface between the computer and display monitor. Usually the recent motherboards incorporate built-in video card.



Figure 1.16 Monitor

The first computer monitor was part of the Xerox Alto computer system, which was released on March 1, 1973.

(2) Plotter: Plotter is an output device that is used to produce graphical output on papers. It uses single color or multi color pens to draw pictures.



Figure 1.17 Plotter

(3) Printers: Printers are used to print the information on papers. Printers are divided into two main categories:

- Impact Printers
- Non Impact printers

Impact Printers

These printers print with striking of hammers or pins on ribbon. These printers can print on multi-part (using carbon papers) by using mechanical pressure. For example, Dot Matrix printers and Line matrix printers are impact printers.



Figure 1.18 Impact Printer

A Dot matrix printer that prints using a fixed number of pins or wires. Each dot is produced by a tiny metal rod, also called a "wire" or "pin", which works by the power of a tiny electromagnet or solenoid, either directly or through a set of small levers. It generally prints one line of text at a time. The printing speed of these printers varies from 30 to 1550 CPS (Character Per Second).

Line matrix printers use a fixed print head for printing. Basically, it prints a page-wide line of dots. But it builds up a line of text by printing lines of dots. Line